

THE KING'S CRUSADE

A Bestiary of Elduvaine, the Occupation, and the Road Between

USING THIS BESTIARY

Every block here was built against real SRD creatures at the same and neighbouring challenge ratings, not against the DMG's Monster Statistics by Challenge Rating table. Measured against that table every humanoid in this book looks badly under-tuned, and so does every humanoid in the SRD: a CR 3 Veteran has 58 hit points where the table asks for 101 to 115. The table describes monsters. These are mostly people, and people are squishier than the arithmetic wants them to be.

Where a creature is deliberately off-baseline it says so in its own entry. Support casters, pack fighters and control-focused adversaries are meant to be individually weak and collectively appalling, and correcting them toward the curve would break the encounters they were built for.

WHAT RESIDENT MAGIC PRODUCES

The creatures in the first section are not monsters that happen to know magic. They are habits with appetites — the same kind of thing as the Willing Road or the Listening Water, given shape because a shape was useful. This has one consequence that runs through every entry: as its region is drained, a resident-magic creature visibly suffers, changes, or goes wrong. None of them are immune to what is being done to Elduvaine, and several of them are the most direct way a party can see it happening.

DM Only: the single best use of this section is not combat. Three of the six creatures below have a nonviolent resolution that is more rewarding than the fight, and one of them cannot meaningfully be fought at all. A party that reaches for initiative every time will get a serviceable campaign. A party that occasionally does not will get this one.

CREATURES OF THE LIVING REALM

Waystone Warden

Large construct, unaligned

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 105 (14d10 + 28)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	6 (–2)	16 (+3)	8 (–1)

Skills: Perception +6

Senses: Truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 16

Languages: understands Elduvish and Sylvan but does not speak

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Unbarred Road. The warden cannot attack, and has no reaction against, any creature that has not offered violence on the Willing Road within the last hour. This is not a moral judgement and cannot be argued with, invoked, or appealed to. It is simply how the thing works, and a party that discovers it has discovered the single most useful fact in this entry.

Stonebound. The warden cannot move more than 120 feet from a waystone. There are three hundred and eleven waystones and it has never been established how the warden chooses between them.

Failing. In a drained region the warden has disadvantage on all attack rolls and its speed is halved. Two have been found stopped entirely, upright, in the road, and nobody has been able to move them.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The warden makes two slam attacks.

Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

Set Aside (Recharge 5-6). The warden lifts one Large or smaller creature it can reach and places it 30 feet away on the road, gently. The target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be moved and knocked prone. This deals no damage. The warden much prefers it to fighting.

DM Only: the warden is a puzzle wearing a stat block. Its first action in almost every encounter should be Set Aside, repeatedly, on whoever is in the way — which reads to players as a fight going strangely and then, about three rounds in, as something else entirely. Do not explain Unbarred Road. Let them work out that the party member who has not attacked is being ignored.

The Withering

Medium fey, neutral

Armor Class: 13

Hit Points: 60 (11d8 + 11)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	18 (+4)

Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: Elvish, Sylvan, Elduvish

Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Was a Dryad. The Withering is what a dryad becomes when the wood it was bound to is drained rather than felled — still alive, still bound, and bound now to something that is no longer there. It is not undead and it is not evil. It is bereaved, and it has been bereaved continuously for somewhere between four months and two years.

Grieving. The Withering has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, and disadvantage on any check made to leave the boundary of what its wood used to be.

Speak with Beasts and Plants. The Withering can communicate with beasts and plants as if they shared a language. Almost nothing answers any more.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Withering makes two claw attacks.

Claw. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 3) slashing damage.

Bitter Bough (Recharge 5-6). Dead wood erupts in a 20-foot radius. Each creature in the area must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) piercing damage on a failure, or half as much on a success. The area becomes difficult terrain.

DM Only: the Withering will stop if anybody tells it, plainly and without softening, what happened to its wood and who did it. Not a Persuasion check — an actual answer, delivered by a player, out loud. It has spent months unable to work out what it did wrong. It is not attacking the party because it is hostile; it is attacking them because they are the first thing to come through and it has no other way to ask. Run the fight, and let somebody talk, and end it the moment they do.

Light-Hollow

Medium construct, unaligned

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 85 (10d8 + 40)

Speed: 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	8 (-1)	18 (+4)	3 (-4)	10 (+0)	1 (-5)

Senses: Blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 10

Languages: —

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP)

Emptied Stone. A Light-Hollow is a piece of Standing Light masonry that was drained past what it could survive. Six centuries of held afternoons came out of it in an afternoon, and what was left got up. There are perhaps forty of them in Elduvaine and every one was somebody's doorstep, lintel or garden wall.

Thirst. Any nonmagical light source within 30 feet of the Light-Hollow is extinguished at the start of the creature's turn. A magical light of 3rd level or lower is suppressed while it remains in range; the caster may make a DC 15 Constitution check at the end of each of their turns to restore it.

Immutable Form. The Light-Hollow is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Light-Hollow makes two slam attacks.

Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d8 + 3) bludgeoning damage.

Draw Down (Recharge 6). The Light-Hollow pulls at every light in a 30-foot radius, its own included. Each creature in the area must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or take 18 (4d8) necrotic damage and be blinded until the end of its next turn. The area is plunged into magical darkness until the start of the Light-Hollow's next turn.

DM Only: fight this in the dark. That is the entire design: Thirst removes the party's torches on round one, Draw Down removes everything else on round three or four, and the encounter becomes a problem about position and memory rather than about damage. A party that thinks to bring a light-stone lamp — which holds daylight rather than making it — finds it works, once, and is worth every copper they paid for it.

Season-Bound Stag

Large fey, neutral good

Armor Class: 13

Hit Points: 45 (6d10 + 12)

Speed: 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Skills: Perception +5, Stealth +5

Senses: passive Perception 15

Languages: understands Sylvan and Elduvish but does not speak

Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Of Its Wood. The stag carries the season of the Kept Season wood that bore it, visibly, wherever it goes — frost on its flanks in high summer, or blossom caught in its antlers in the depth of winter, always the wrong one, always four days or nine weeks into it. It is the most photographed thing in Elduvaine, in the sense that every visiting scholar for four centuries has tried to draw one.

Season's Passage. The stag ignores difficult terrain and cannot be tracked by nonmagical means.

Skittish. The stag will not initiate combat and flees at the first opportunity. It has no morale to break; it simply leaves.

ACTIONS

Ram. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 12 (2d8 + 3) bludgeoning damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Turn of the Year (1/Day). The stag stamps once. Every creature within 30 feet that can see it regains 9 (2d8) hit

points and is cured of one level of exhaustion. It does this for reasons nobody has established and to whoever happens to be standing there, including, on two recorded occasions, an occupation patrol.

Echo of the Listening Water

Medium elemental, unaligned

Armor Class: 12

Hit Points: 27 (6d8)

Speed: 0 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (-2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: speaks only what it has heard

Challenge: 1 (200 XP)

Not a Monster. An Echo forms where a great deal was said at a water's edge over a long time and the water has more of it than it can hold. It has no hostility and no plan. It surfaces, it repeats, and it goes.

In the Speaker's Voice. Everything the Echo says is something a real person said at that water, in that person's own voice, exactly as they said it. It does not paraphrase, cannot lie, and has no idea what any of it means.

Watery Form. The Echo can move through a space as narrow as one inch wide without squeezing, and has resistance to bludgeoning, piercing and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks.

ACTIONS

Drench. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 7 (2d4 + 2) cold damage. The Echo does this only if struck first, and does it apologetically, in somebody else's voice.

Give Back. The Echo repeats up to a minute of speech spoken at its water at any point in the last thirty years, chosen by the DM. This is the reason the creature is in this book.

DM Only: the Echo is the Four Voices technique with a stat block attached, for tables that want the delivery mechanism to be a thing in the room rather than a riverbank. Use it when the party needs to hear something that happened somewhere they were not, and give them the court's version, the commons' version, the proclamation and the private grief, in four different voices, none of them lying and none of them complete. Do not let anybody fight it. If they attack it, it leaves.

Draining Engine

Large construct, unaligned

Armor Class: 17 (plated)

Hit Points: 115 (11d10 + 55)

Speed: 0 ft. (cart-mounted)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	6 (-2)	20 (+5)	1 (-5)	8 (-1)	1 (-5)

Senses: Blindsight 30 ft., passive Perception 9

Languages: —

Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

What It Is For. An Engine does not fight. An Engine drains, in a slow radius, into cut light-stone that is then carted to Vindana and sold. There are perhaps thirty of them in Elduvaine and between them they are the reason the kingdom is dying. Everything below is what an Engine does when interrupted, which is not what it was built for and is quite bad enough.

Drawing. While the Engine is running, every creature within 60 feet that is native to Elduvaine — including fey, resident-magic creatures, and any character with an Elduvish habit-based feature — has disadvantage on saving throws. The effect is not targeted and cannot be resisted; it is simply happening to the whole field.

Warded Plate. The Engine has resistance to bludgeoning, piercing and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks, and is immune to poison and psychic damage.

ACTIONS

Discharge. Ranged Spell Attack: +7 to hit, range 60 ft., one target. Hit: 22 (4d10) force damage.

Vent (Recharge 5-6). The Engine dumps what it has taken in a 30-foot radius. Each creature in the area must make a DC 16 Constitution saving throw, taking 27 (6d8) force damage on a failure, or half as much on a success. Every plant in the area dies. This is what it looks like when Elduvaine is spent, and it should be described that way.

DM Only: an Engine is an objective, not an opponent, and the encounter around it should be built that way: Legion troops defending it while a clock runs, and the Engine itself as terrain that hurts. Breaking one is a real and permanent win — there are only about thirty — and the party should be told the number so that they can feel the arithmetic. It is also the campaign's cleanest answer to a table that wants to hurt Vale before Module Eleven.

THE SIXTH FREE LEGION

Vale did not raise a horde. He hired an army that was already good at this, on a written contract, with a pay schedule and a reputation to protect — a hobgoblin professional core with orc, human and goblin auxiliaries and a stratum of Elduvish collaborator clerks doing the paperwork. The Sixth has been in business for a hundred and forty years, has fought for six different employers, and has never once broken a contract, which is the only reason anybody hires it.

The blocks below are the Legion as an institution: drilled, disciplined, and individually unremarkable. Their strength is that they do not break, they do not chase, and they do not do anything stupid. Every one of them has explicit morale, because a professional army has explicit morale, and a party that gives the Sixth a reason to withdraw will find it withdraws in good order and takes its wounded.

Legionary of the Sixth

Medium humanoid (any race), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 18 (chain mail, shield)

Hit Points: 22 (4d8 + 4)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	9 (-1)

Skills: Athletics +4, Perception +2

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: Common, Goblin

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP)

Formation. The legionary has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one other legionary is within 5 feet of that creature and is not incapacitated. This is not flanking; it is drill, and it works whether or not the table uses flanking rules.

Contracted. The Sixth withdraws in good order when a fight has clearly been lost, when its officer orders it, or when its pay is in doubt. It does not fight to the last man for anybody, and Vale is not an exception.

ACTIONS

Legion Pike. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 7 (1d10 + 2) piercing damage.

Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Light Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +3 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d8 + 1) piercing damage.

Legion Optio

Medium humanoid (any race), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 18 (chain mail, shield)

Hit Points: 44 (8d8 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws: Wis +4

Skills: Athletics +5, Perception +4

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: Common, Goblin

Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Deliberately Off-Baseline. An Optio is a force multiplier and is tuned as one: the armour class is high for the challenge rating and the damage is not. Do not correct this. An Optio alone is a soft CR 2; an Optio with six legionaries is the reason the encounter works.

Formation. As the legionary.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The optio makes two longsword attacks.

Longsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage.

Dress the Line (Recharge 5-6). Up to six legionaries within 30 feet that can hear the optio may each immediately move up to half their speed without provoking opportunity attacks, and gain 5 temporary hit points.

REACTIONS

Hold. When a creature within 30 feet that can hear the optio fails a saving throw against being frightened, that creature may reroll the save. The optio is not inspiring anybody. The optio is shouting a number.

Legion Ironshank

Medium humanoid (any race), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 19 (splint, shield)

Hit Points: 60 (8d8 + 24)

Speed: 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Str +6, Con +5

Skills: Athletics +6

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Common, Goblin

Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Immovable. The ironshank has advantage on saving throws and ability checks made to resist being moved, knocked prone, or shoved, and its speed cannot be reduced below 10 feet.

Shield Wall. While within 5 feet of another ironshank, both have three-quarters cover against ranged attacks.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The ironshank makes two maul attacks, or one maul attack and one shield bash.

Maul. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Shield Bash. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be pushed 10 feet and knocked prone.

REACTIONS

Parry. The ironshank adds 3 to its AC against one melee attack that would hit it. To do so, it must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

Legion Battle-Mage

Medium humanoid (any race), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 15 (bracers)

Hit Points: 66 (12d8 + 12)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (–1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws: Int +7, Wis +5

Skills: Arcana +7, History +7

Senses: passive Perception 11

Languages: Common, Goblin, Draconic

Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Deliberately Off-Baseline. Low hit points for the challenge rating, exactly as the SRD Mage is at CR 6 with 40. A battle-mage is a threat because of what it does on round one and a corpse if it is reached on round two, and the whole encounter is about which of those happens.

Spellcasting. The battle-mage is a 9th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). It has the following wizard spells prepared: Cantrips (at will): fire bolt, light, mage hand, prestidigitation; 1st level (4 slots): magic missile, shield, thunderwave; 2nd level (3 slots): misty step, scorching ray, web; 3rd level (3 slots): counterspell, fireball, fly; 4th level (3 slots): ice storm, wall of fire; 5th level (1 slot): cone of cold.

Hired, Not Devoted. The battle-mage is on the same contract as everybody else and has the same withdrawal terms. It will surrender if the alternative is dying for an employer whose kingdom is visibly running out, and several have.

ACTIONS

Dagger. Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

NAMED FIGURES

Blocks for people the party is likely to fight beside rather than against. All of them are built as people rather than as monsters, which means they sit below the DMG's curve in exactly the way the SRD's own humanoids do.

Xavier III of Harrowmark

Medium humanoid (human), lawful good

Armor Class: 20 (plate, shield)

Hit Points: 130 (that is 17d8 + 51, and he has been at this a long time)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws: Str +8, Con +7, Wis +6

Skills: Athletics +8, Insight +6, Persuasion +8, Survival +6

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: Common, Marchspeak, Ninefold Cant

Challenge: 8 (3,900 XP)

Excellent Commander, Indifferent King. Xavier is at his best in exactly the situation this stat block describes and at his worst in a council chamber. Play the difference. He is decisive, physically brave, personally warm to soldiers, and visibly relieved to be doing something he is good at.

Brave. Xavier has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Chose Them Himself. Xavier picked this party personally and will say so, in front of people, at moments when it is politically expensive for him to do it.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Xavier makes three longsword attacks.

Longsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 12 (1d10 + 7) slashing damage, or 13 (1d12 + 7) when used with two hands.

Rally (1/Day). Every friendly creature within 60 feet that can hear Xavier gains 20 temporary hit points and advantage on attack rolls until the end of their next turn.

REACTIONS

Parry. Xavier adds 3 to his AC against one melee attack that would hit him. To do so, he must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

DM Only: Xavier earns the name Wyvernheart airborne, mid-siege, at Vindana, in a battle that is going badly. No document may use the name in narration set before that moment and the Player Guide does not hint that a name is coming. His stat block does not change when he earns it. That is the point: nothing about him is different afterwards except what he is called.

Aveline Ysolde, the Regent

Medium humanoid (human), lawful good

Armor Class: 15 (studded leather)

Hit Points: 66 (12d8 + 12)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Dex +6, Int +5

Skills: Deception +6, Insight +6, Perception +6, Stealth +9, Survival +6

Senses: passive Perception 16

Languages: Common, Elduvish, Marchspeak, Writ-tongue

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP)

Unremarkable. Aveline has advantage on Charisma (Deception) checks made to pass as an ordinary person of any station, and on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made in an inhabited place. Three years uncaught in a kingdom where everyone else is known.

Cunning Action. On each of her turns, Aveline can use a bonus action to take the Dash, Disengage, or Hide action.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn). Aveline deals an extra 14 (4d6) damage when she hits with a finesse or ranged weapon attack and has advantage, or when another enemy of the target is within 5 feet of it.

Will Not Be Evacuated. She has refused in writing, twice, to two different coalition commanders who put it to her as a kindness. She will refuse the party as well, and the refusal is not negotiable and is not a puzzle to be solved.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Aveline makes two attacks with her shortsword.

Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Hand Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Huntmaster Brenna Vane

Medium humanoid (dwarf), neutral good

Armor Class: 16 (breastplate)

Hit Points: 58 (9d8 + 18)

Speed: 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws: Con +5, Wis +6

Skills: Animal Handling +6, Athletics +6, Perception +6, Survival +8

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 16

Languages: Common, Dwarvish, Marchspeak

Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Two Centuries of This. Brenna has advantage on attack rolls against any creature with a flying speed, and on saving throws against being frightened by one. She has been killing wyverns since before Xavier's grandfather was born and finds the whole business tedious rather than heroic.

Pike Drill. Brenna and any friendly creature within 5 feet of her have advantage on attack rolls of opportunity, and their reach weapons deal an extra 3 damage against a creature that entered their reach this turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Brenna makes two attacks with her wyvern pike.

Wyvern Pike. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 10 (1d12 + 3) piercing damage. On a hit

against a creature with a flying speed, the target must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be pulled 10 feet toward Brenna and knocked prone.

Handaxe. Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) slashing damage.

Doria Kell

Medium humanoid (tiefling), neutral

Armor Class: 14 (fine leather, under considerably finer clothes)

Hit Points: 45 (10d8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	17 (+3)	15 (+2)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws: Int +6, Cha +7

Skills: Deception +7, History +6, Insight +8, Investigation +9, Persuasion +10

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: Common, Infernal, Writ-tongue, Elduvish, Goblin

Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Not a Combatant. Doria has a stat block because parties are unpredictable, not because this encounter is intended. She will not fight. She will leave, and the house will note it, and every price the party is ever quoted afterward will reflect the note.

The Letter of It. Doria has advantage on any check made to draft, read, or find the flaw in a written agreement, and she cannot be deceived about the contents of one she has read.

Genuinely Takes No Side. This is not a pose and is not a secret allegiance waiting to be uncovered. Norvatch priced a situation it did not create and has traded inside that price for three years. She will say so to anybody who asks and will not be embarrassed by it.

ACTIONS

Dagger. Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

Innate Spellcasting. Doria can cast thaumaturgy at will, and hellish rebuke (2nd level) and darkness once each per day. Charisma is her spellcasting ability (save DC 15). She regards all three as vulgar and uses them only when leaving.

MAELIS YSOLDE

There is no stat block for the Sovereign of Elduvaine, and the omission is deliberate.

She has not stood unaided since the second winter of the occupation. She cannot fight, cannot flee, cannot be usefully protected, and cannot be carried out of Caer Ysolde without a question nobody can answer about what leaving would do

to the habits bound to her. Anything a party does in a room with Maelis Ysolde is a conversation, and a DM who wants numbers for her should use her Intelligence, which is 20, and her Wisdom, which is 20, and remember that she has had three years of confinement with nothing whatsoever to do except think about the man holding her.

DM Only: if a table insists on a mechanical handle: she has passive Insight 20, she cannot be lied to about Elduvaine, and she knows more about Maedoc Vale than anyone alive including Vale. That is the whole of it. Do not give her hit

points. The moment she has hit points, some table somewhere will find out what happens when they run out, and this campaign is better without that scene in it.

CREATURES BY REGION

SRD creatures used by name in the modules and the gazetteer, without a reprinted block, because they are unmodified and a DM can look them up in seconds.

Where	What lives there
Harrowmark	Wyvern (CR 6), bandit (CR 1/8), wolf (CR 1/4), hill giant (CR 5), guard (CR 1/8)
The sea road	Merrow (CR 2), giant octopus (CR 1), sahuagin (CR 1/2)
The mountain road	Kobold (CR 1/8), ogre (CR 2), griffon (CR 2), troll (CR 5), giant eagle (CR 1)
The Vaunt	Sprite (CR 1/4), ghoul (CR 1), scout (CR 1/2), giant crab (CR 1/8)
The Braid	Will-o'-wisp (CR 2), spy (CR 1), veteran (CR 3), mage (CR 6)
The Orchard Marches	Dryad (CR 1), winter wolf (CR 3), troll (CR 5), satyr (CR 1/2), awakened tree (CR 2)
The Standing Marches	Gargoyle (CR 2), earth elemental (CR 5), stone giant (CR 7)
Vindana's undercity	Kobold (CR 1/8), giant rat (CR 1/8), grey ooze (CR 1/2), otyugh (CR 5)

Coverage here is SRD-only. There is no Volo's and no Mordenkainen's in this book, and anything a DM imports from those is unvalidated against the encounter maths the modules were built with.

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"It set me down in the road. Twice. Very carefully, like a man moving a chair. And then it went back and stood by the stone, and it did not look at me again, and I have thought about it every day since."

— a carter of Lisswater, deposition to the Magistrate